

Andrew De Spain

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical Artist with 3+ years of game-development experience specializing in Unreal Engine asset integration, rigging, animation pipelines, destruction systems, and Python tools. Experienced collaborating across Art, Animation, Design, and FX teams to troubleshoot pipelines, improve workflows, and deliver production-ready gameplay assets.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

Recognition: Recognized by an original Halo developer during an executive-level demonstration for Warthog vehicle rigging, initial design tuning, and hybrid-engine integration.

Cross-Team Support: Served as a point of contact for Dynamic Object Workflows and integration support across multiple teams at Halo Studios.

Awards: Contributed to two College Emmy Award-winning student films.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Halo Studios (Aquent LLC) - Halo: Campaign Evolved | Redmond, WA / Hybrid

Technical Artist | December 2024 - Present

Character and Vehicle Integration: Supported asset integration into Halo Studios' hybrid Unreal Engine pipeline. Authored collision and physics meshes for 10 characters and several vehicles and assisted Game Design with initial gameplay character and vehicle setup.

Destruction Systems: Partnered with FX and Game Design to build and integrate debris systems, tune damage behaviors, and provide technical guidance on gameplay-driven destruction workflows.

Rigging: Designed and implemented a skeleton and control rig for the Warthog using a custom Python system. Supported Animation and Design by debugging, skinning, and refining functionality across multiple vehicle and character rigs.

Legacy Animation Retargeting: Audited thousands of legacy animation sequences, developed scripts supporting retargeting for 10 characters, and helped resolve legacy animation-state systems used by gameplay.

Neon Machine - SHRAPNEL | Seattle, WA

Technical Artist (Rigging) | August 2023 - September 2024

Character Integration: Prepared, managed, and integrated multiple MetaHuman characters into Unreal Engine in collaboration with the character team.

Character Customization Systems: Supported customization workflows by skinning and weight-painting more than 50 sci-fi and military-style clothing assets and integrating them into the game's customization system.

Research and Development: Helped develop solutions for character-customization pipelines, engine-integration workflows, and icon-rendering systems covering hundreds of weapon and character skins.

Brigham Young University - Student Capstone Projects | Provo, UT

Rigging TD and Technical Animator | January 2022 - June 2023

Rigging: Created five facial rigs, five mechanical rigs, five biped rigs, two quadruped rigs, and multiple prop rigs across two game and two film productions.

Team Leadership: Led and mentored five technical artists, taught rigging workflows, and ensured completed rigs met the animation team's creative and technical requirements.

Animation and Lighting: Animated three shots and lit four shots for a senior capstone film and created idle and movement animations for student game projects.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Technical Art: Unreal Engine, Maya, Python, PyQt, Blueprints, Rigging, Animation Retargeting, Character and Vehicle Integration, Collision and Physics Meshes, Mesh and LOD Generation (Havok, Simplygon), Destruction Systems, Skinning and Weight Painting, Pipeline Development

Production Tools: Perforce, Jira, Adobe Creative Suite

SELECTED PROJECTS

Halo: Campaign Evolved | Xbox Series X|S, PlayStation 5, PC | Technical Artist | Announced release: July 28, 2026

SHRAPNEL | PC | Technical Artist (Rigging) | Released March 12, 2026

EDUCATION

Brigham Young University | Bachelor of Fine Arts | May 2023 | Provo, UT

Salt Lake Community College | Associate of Science | April 2019 | Salt Lake City, UT